Q+A

MUSIC of The SPHERES

Amish Tripathi *collaborates with rock band Trilok as a vocalist for a contemporary rendition of the 'Shiv Tandav Stotram'*



Q. The 'Shiv Tandav Stotram' is an ancient Sanskrit hymn. Why give it a rock music treatment?

The 'Shiv Tandav Stotram' is raw energy put into Sanskrit verse by Raavan, in honour of Lord Shiva. The words themselves carry a natural percussion. It felt obvious that they could blend with a high-intensity modern soundscape of rock.

Q. You are known as an author, diplomat and broadcaster. Why was singing hidden away?

I was the lead singer of our IIM-Calcutta band decades ago, and then the demands of a banking career, and later writing and public life, simply drowned the music out. This song is a return to singing after nearly 30 years.

Q. Are similar collaborations on the cards in the near future?

When you taste this kind of creative fusion, you do not want to stop. There have already been discussions about exploring other Sanskrit and vernacular stotrams and bhajans in contemporary musical forms.

Q. What's the next project we can look forward to?

I have completed a children's book that should be out soon, and I am on the verge of finishing a crime fiction novel set in the UK. There is also *Age of Bhaarat,* which will be the first big-budget video game on an Indian subject.

—with Amit Dixit

Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**